CLASS 8 — ENGLISH RUSKIN BOND · HARD LEVEL CHAPTER TEST SET 1

Chapter 11: **The Child's Story** | RBSE Pattern | Session 2026–27

Time: 1 Hour 30 Minutes Name: _____ Roll No.: _____ **Maximum Marks: 40**

General Instructions:

1. All questions are compulsory.
2. Q. 1–10 are Objective Type (1 mark each).
3. Q. 11–14 are Very Short Answer Type (2 marks each).
4. Q. 15–18 are Short Answer Type (3 marks each).
5. Q. 19–20 are Long Answer Type (5 marks each).
6. Internal choice is given in Q. 17 to 20.
7. Write the question number before each answer.
8. Hard level: application and higher-order questions.

SECTION — A (Objective Type Questions) 10 × 1 = 10

Choose the correct option and write it in your answer book.

1. The phrase 'a magic journey' that 'seemed very long when he began it, and very short halfway' most strongly suggests: 1

(a) he rode a horse **(b)** life seems to speed up as we age
(c) the traveller walked fast **(d)** the road was shortened by magic

2. The phrase 'never to be strange to one another all their lives through' tells us that the friends: 1

(a) were already strangers **(b)** would soon forget
(c) would always be close **(d)** would quarrel

3. Which emotion is most strongly expressed at the end of the gentleman's journey? 1

(a) boredom **(b)** calm acceptance after grief
(c) rage at the world **(d)** joy at winning

4. Which of the following is the best reason the author calls the wood path 'dark' at the start? 1

(a) the traveller was afraid of animals
(b) the future is unknown at the beginning of life
(c) the trees were burning
(d) it was night

5. The reference to 'Fanny in the corner there' is an example of the narrator: 1

(a) directly addressing his listeners **(b)** using a flashback
(c) changing the plot **(d)** writing a diary

6. The sunset shining before them through the trees stands for: 1

(a) the closing years of life **(b)** a stormy sea
(c) a fire **(d)** a festival

7. Read: 'When it snowed, that was best of all.' What does this sentence show about the child's world? 1

(a) children dislike snow **(b)** snow is dangerous
(c) even weather is a source of joy **(d)** snow brings sadness

8. Which of the following is NOT a likely reason the writer uses humour in the young man's story? 1

(a) to connect with the audience **(b)** to keep the tone warm
(c) to make the story lively **(d)** to mock the reader's family

9. The traveller loses his last friend 'among the branches'. In figurative terms, this signals: 1

(a) a change of school **(b)** a game of hide and seek
(c) a lost map **(d)** the end of companionship through death

10. Which of the following sentences contains an example of onomatopoeia? 1

(a) The boy was always learning. **(b)** The old man sat on a tree.
(c) The wind came whistling and howling. **(d)** The sky was so blue.

SECTION — B (Very Short Answer Type) — 4 × 2 = 8

Answer in about 20–30 words each.

11. Why does the author describe the weather in so much detail in the child's stage? 2

12. Why does the narrator say the girl was 'just like Fanny'? 2

13. What is the importance of the gentleman's hair turning grey and then white? 2

14. What is the effect of the phrase 'all new and all true' about the picture-books? 2

SECTION — C (Short Answer Type) — 4 × 3 = 12

Answer in about 40–60 words each.

15. Read: 'Come and play with me!' Why is this invitation important for the first stage of life? 3

16. Examine the line 'I pray not yet.' What does it reveal about human feelings? 3

17. Rewrite in reported speech: The child said, 'I am always at play.' 3

OR

Explain how the repetition 'I am always ...' creates a pattern in the story. 3

18. How is the first child's call, 'Mother, mother!', significant? 3

OR

Make a sentence with each homophone pair: 'principal - principle' and 'council - counsel'. 3

SECTION — D (Long Answer Type) — 2 × 5 = 10

Answer in about 100–150 words each.

19. Read the extract: 'And I think the traveller must be yourself, dear Grandfather, because this what you do to us, and what we do to you.' Explain the context and the significance of these words. 5

OR

You are Grandfather. Write a letter to the grandchild who told you this story. 5

20. 'Each stage of life is complete in itself.' Discuss with reference to the story. 5

OR

Compare the traveller's first friend (the child) with his last friend (the old man). 5

END OF QUESTION PAPER — **Total: 40 Marks**